

Women in Aquaculture

Gender Equity Framework for Aquaculture

A Practical Guide for Organisations

Women in Aquaculture (WiA)

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This publication is produced by Women in Aquaculture (WiA), a global non-profit platform
connecting, supporting and celebrating women across the aquaculture industry.

Introduction

This framework provides aquaculture organisations with a structured approach to assessing and improving gender equity. It covers five pillars: inclusive recruitment, equitable workplace, leadership pipeline, data and accountability, and culture and voice.

Whether you are a small farm, a research institution, or a multinational corporation, this framework can be adapted to your context and scale.

The Five Pillars

Pillar 1: Inclusive Recruitment

- Use gender-neutral language in job descriptions
- Ensure gender-balanced shortlists for all positions
- Offer flexible interview arrangements (timing, location, format)
- Review selection criteria for unconscious bias
- Track application and hiring rates by gender

Pillar 2: Equitable Workplace

- Conduct annual pay equity audits and close identified gaps
- Implement robust anti-harassment and anti-discrimination policies
- Offer equal parental leave regardless of gender
- Provide flexible working arrangements where possible
- Ensure safe and gender-appropriate facilities (PPE, sanitation)

Pillar 3: Leadership Pipeline

- Establish sponsorship programmes pairing women with senior leaders
- Fund women's participation in leadership training and conferences
- Include gender targets in succession planning
- Create visibility for women leaders as role models and speakers

Pillar 4: Data & Accountability

- Collect and report workforce data disaggregated by gender
- Set measurable equity targets with timelines
- Assign board-level accountability for equity progress
- Publish an annual gender equity report

Pillar 5: Culture & Voice

- Support employee resource groups for women
 - Include diverse voices in decision-making processes
 - Establish anonymous feedback mechanisms
 - Celebrate women's achievements and contributions publicly
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Implementation Roadmap

Phase 1: Assess (Months 1-3)

Conduct a baseline gender audit. Gather data on workforce composition, pay gaps, promotion rates, and employee satisfaction by gender. Identify priority areas for action.

Phase 2: Plan (Months 3-6)

Develop an action plan based on audit findings. Set measurable targets for each pillar. Assign accountability and allocate budget.

Phase 3: Implement (Months 6-12)

Focus on quick wins (policy updates, training) alongside structural changes (pay adjustments, recruitment redesign). Communicate changes clearly to all staff.

Phase 4: Monitor (Ongoing)

Track progress quarterly. Publish annual reports. Adjust targets based on results. Share learnings with the broader industry.

Self-Assessment Checklist

Use this checklist to evaluate your organisation's current position:

- Do we have a written gender equity policy?
- Have we conducted a pay equity audit in the last 12 months?
- Are our job descriptions reviewed for gender-biased language?
- Do we offer equal parental leave regardless of gender?

- Is there a formal process for reporting harassment or discrimination?
- Are leadership programmes accessible to women at all levels?
- Do we track and report workforce data disaggregated by gender?
- Is there board-level accountability for gender equity targets?